PERMISSION, PRINTED & KEPT

# It Is Okay to Cancel

You printed this because the thought crossed your mind — or you're keeping it on hand for the day it does. Either way, welcome. Parties are supposed to add to a life, not subtract from it. A small, tender celebration carries permission to get smaller, to move, or to pause.

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## How to use it

1. Read the three big lines on page 2 before reading anything else. They're true whether or not you end up canceling.
2. Pick the box that matches you *today* — smaller, moved, or canceled — and let yourself be an honest person about it.
3. Page 3 holds words that work for a message among friends: no essays required. Copy one, edit it lightly, or write your own.
4. If you're running a fever, cancel early and cancel kindly — people accepted your invite because they like you, not the catering.
5. Keep this card afterward. It works for the next party, and quietly for a lot of other things too.

## What's inside

- **Page 2** — the permission lines and three honest paths.
- **Page 3** — short, kind messages you can send: canceled, moved, made smaller.

> **A kind note:** this card is a way to choose one party kindly, not a way to dodge everyone forever. There's a difference, and you'll know which one you're holding.

Print at 100% (“Actual size”), US Letter, portrait. Prints nicely in black & white. Personal use: print as many copies as you like.

# It Is Okay to Cancel

A permission card for one small party that got heavy.

It is okay to need the party smaller than you planned.

It is okay to move the party to a week that has room for it.

It is okay to cancel a gathering because you cannot bear one — the people who love you would rather see you than see the setup.

### Keep it, make it small ☐

Two friends, a kitchen table, and soup is a real party.

Appetizers and tea on the porch count as celebration.

Feeling better mid-week? Text one person. Done — that's a party.

### Take a breath, pick a new date ☐

New date, if it's decided: _____

A “moved — details soon” text today buys a very calm tomorrow.

The countdown sheet doesn't mind being printed and used twice.

### Cancel this one, kindly ☐

Canceling early is a courtesy, not a confession.

The food plan can rest, or be carried over to the next chance.

Your people will still be your people on the other side of this.

**A kind note:** a party built on dread serves no one — not you, not the guest of honor, not the cake. Choosing kindly is the work this card does.

# Words That Work

Short messages among friends — copy, edit lightly, send.

### If it's canceled

Hi all — I'm canceling Saturday's gathering. I've been running on empty and I need a quiet weekend to refill. Nothing is wrong, and it isn't anyone. I'd rather give the party a real chance another time than a tired one now. Miss you, and thanks for the RSVPs.

### If it's moving

Quick heads-up: I'm moving the party to _____ — the week got away from me and I'd like to host you properly instead of halfway. Save the date; everything else stays.

### If it's getting smaller

Taking the party small this time — just a few of us at the kitchen table on _____. Don't read into it; the room is just cozier than my week. If we miss you Saturday, we'll owe you the next one.

### If you're going but it's a low-battery day

I'm coming, but I might slip out early — if you see me hovering near my coat, that's me, not you. Save me one square of the good dessert.

**Said plainly:** a “no” sent kindly, early, is one of the most considerate things you can mail. Everyone else reschedules their plans around one text instead of one mystery.